Skybirds Website: Issues Report

Covers the user website, admin panel and API (`skybird-user-frontend`, `skybird-admin`, `skybird-api`) · 28 October 2026

This report lists everything found in a code audit of all three apps and a hands-on walk-through of every page in a browser, on desktop (1280px) and mobile (390px). Each issue has an ID, where it is in the code, what goes wrong, and a suggested fix.

7	10	11	4	3
Critical: breaks for users or the business	Backend issues	Functional & navigation	Visual / UI	Minor / clean-up

Recommended fix order

1. **C2:** confirm where the live API runs and whether lesson videos survive restarts. This is the most likely reason videos don't play.
2. **C1:** keep lessons playing past 5 minutes.
3. **C4:** remove the default admin password from the login page, and change it if it still works.
4. **C3:** make sure every paying student gets access (Razorpay webhook + payment records).
5. **F1–F3:** fix the login/session problems.
6. **C5, C6:** uploads and OTP limits.
7. Then the rest of the backend, visual and minor items.

1. Critical issues

ID	Issue	Where	What goes wrong / Fix
C1	**Lessons stop playing after about 5 minutes** CRITICAL	`skybird-api/services/playbackService.js:10` `controllers/videoController.js:55-67` `user-frontend/src/components/ProtectedVideo.jsx`	The playback token expires after 300 s and the player never asks for a new one, so every video segment after that is refused. Lessons run up to about 13 min. **Fix:** when the player gets a 410 error, fetch a new token and resume at the same second. Short term: set `PLAYBACK_TOKEN_TTL_SECONDS` to 1800 or more.
C2	**Lesson videos missing on the server** CRITICAL	`skybird-api/private-videos/hls/` `user-frontend/src/api/axios.js:4-6`	The live database lists 11 lessons, but 10 of their video folders don't exist on this machine. The code says the API runs on Render's free tier, whose disk is wiped on every redeploy or restart. When that happens, all lessons return "Video not found". **Fix:** attach a persistent disk and point `VIDEO_STORAGE_PATH` at it, or move videos to S3/R2 or a video service. Re-upload any missing lessons.

C3	**A student can pay and not get the course** CRITICAL	`skybird-api/controllers/paymentController.js:141` `user-frontend/src/components/PaymentModal.jsx:112`	Access is granted only if the browser calls `/payment/razorpay/verify` after paying. If the tab closes or the network drops, the money is taken and no access is given. There is no Razorpay webhook and no record of payments. **Fix:** add a signed Razorpay webhook (`order.paid`) that runs the same grant logic, and store each payment in a `Payment` collection.
C4	**Admin login shows the default password** CRITICAL	`skybird-admin/src/pages/Login.jsx:8, 89` `skybird-api/controllers/authController.js:345`	The form comes pre-filled with `admin123` and shows "Default: admin@example.com / admin123" to everyone. The server-side block is commented out. If that account exists, anyone can take over the site. (Screenshot in section 5.) **Fix:** remove the pre-fill and the hint, and change any admin password that is still `admin123`.
C5	**Long video uploads time out** HIGH	`skybird-api/controllers/adminController.js:57` `services/videoService.js:36`	The upload request waits while ffmpeg converts the whole video, which takes minutes. The browser or proxy gives up after about 60 s and the admin sees "failed". Conversion keeps running and leaves an orphan video folder, and the admin uploads again. **Fix:** return the videoId immediately, convert in the background (one at a time), and let the admin panel poll for "processing / ready / failed".
C6	**OTP limit shared by the whole site behind a proxy** HIGH	`skybird-api/middleware/rateLimit.js:5` `server.js:33, 76-81`	With `TRUST_PROXY=false` behind Render/Nginx/Cloudflare, every visitor appears as the same IP. The whole site then gets only 3 OTPs per 15 minutes. There is also no limit per phone number, so someone can run up your SMS bill by requesting OTPs for many numbers. **Fix:** set `TRUST_PROXY=true`, and allow at most one OTP per number per 60 s.
C7	**Wrong video folder in .env** FIXED	`skybird-api/.env:26`	A stray backtick (`./private-videos``) made the API read videos from an empty folder. Fixed during this review; the API must be restarted to pick it up.

2. Backend issues (API)

ID	Issue	Where	What goes wrong / Fix
B1	**CORS lets every website call the API** HIGH	`skybird-api/server.js:48` `.env CLIENT_URL`	`|| origin` allows any site, so the allow-list does nothing. Also, `CLIENT_URL` ends with "/", which never matches a browser origin, so the live site would be blocked once the bug is fixed. **Fix:** remove `|| origin` and list the exact origins without a trailing slash (main site, www, admin).

B2	**Coupon usage limits can be exceeded** MEDIUM	`services/couponService.js:75-83` `paymentController.js:291-300`	The limit is checked when checkout starts, but uses are counted only after payment. Fifty people can all use a "first 10 buyers" coupon. **Fix:** reserve the use at order creation with a conditional update (`usedCount < usageLimit`).
B3	**Deleted lessons keep their video files forever** MEDIUM	`controllers/adminController.js:447-476`	Only testimonials delete their video folder, so the disk slowly fills with unused videos. **Fix:** when a lesson is removed, delete its folder if no other course or testimonial uses it.
B4	**Deleting a customer erases their purchase history** MEDIUM	`controllers/adminController.js:553`	Purchases live only inside the user record. Deleting a customer leaves no record for refunds or disputes. **Fix:** the `Payment` collection from C3 keeps them; consider blocking customers instead of deleting them.
B5	**No automated tests** MEDIUM	`whole repo`	Payment verification and video access checks have no tests. A small change could give courses away or lock out paying students. **Fix:** add `node:test` + supertest tests for verify (bad signature, wrong user, success once) and playback (non-owner gets 403).
B6	**Admin dashboard loads every user** LOW	`controllers/adminController.js:585`	The purchase count loads every user into memory, which gets slower as users grow. **Fix:** count with a MongoDB aggregate using `$size`.
B7	**Upload limit silently capped at 2 GB** LOW	`middleware/upload.js:39`	`.env` says 10 GB, but the code caps uploads at 2 GB, so a 3 GB upload fails with a confusing error. **Fix:** set `.env` to the real limit.
B8	**If Cloudinary fails, thumbnails are stored inside the course** LOW	`controllers/adminController.js:34-41`	If Cloudinary fails, an image of up to 8 MB is saved as text in the course record and sent to every visitor. **Fix:** return an error instead.
B9	**Dead code and unused packages** LOW	`package.json`, `customerController.js:24`, `courseController.js:144`, `testimonialController.js:123`	`express-validator` is unused; `uuid` can be replaced by `crypto.randomUUID()`; the disabled `/customer/purchase` and `/courses/:id/stream` endpoints; the missing `salePrice` field; a no-op replace. **Fix:** delete them (about 60 lines and 2 dependencies).
B10	**Secrets and docs** MEDIUM	`skybird-api/.env`, `README.md`	Live payment, database, cloud and SMS keys sit in plain text in `.env`. If this folder was ever zipped or shared, change all of them. The README describes Twilio, but the code uses APITxT. **Fix:** rotate the keys if they were shared; update the README.

3. Functional & navigation issues (frontend)

ID	Issue	Where	What goes wrong / Fix
F1	**An expired session still looks logged in** HIGH	`user-frontend/src/api/axios.js:20`	On a 401 the token is removed from storage but not from the app state. Reproduced: the navbar still showed the name and Logout while every API call failed. **Fix:** on 401, call `logout()` from UserContext and redirect to `/login`.
F2	**Expired session tells paying students they own nothing** HIGH	`user-frontend/src/pages/Dashboard.jsx`	The dashboard shows "Owned courses 0. No courses yet, buy a course" instead of "please log in again". (Screenshot in section 5.) **Fix:** handled by F1; also show an error state when loading purchases fails.
F3	**Login doesn't return you to where you were** MEDIUM	`user-frontend/src/pages/Login.jsx:113, 134`	A student who clicks "Buy" and logs in lands on `/courses` or `/dashboard`, not back on the course. **Fix:** `navigate(from || res.redirectTo)`.
F4	**Video player reads the API address differently** MEDIUM	`ProtectedVideo.jsx:6` `skybird-user-frontend/.env`	The player reads `VITE_API_URL` with no fallback, while the rest of the site falls back to the Render address. If it's missing, courses load but videos fail. `.env` points to localhost. **Fix:** use `API.defaults.baseURL`; add `.env.production`.
F5	**`/payment/success` is a fake page** MEDIUM	`user-frontend/src/pages/PaymentSuccess.jsx:8, 31, 42`	Anyone who opens it sees "Course Unlocked!", a made-up transaction ID and "verified through PayU", but payments use Razorpay. Nothing links to it. **Fix:** delete the page (and `/payment/failure`), or show real data from the order.
F6	**Bad lesson link shows an error** LOW	`user-frontend/src/pages/Watch.jsx:127-132`	`/watch/…?v=<wrong id>` shows "This lesson is not configured" instead of opening the first lesson. **Fix:** fall back to `course.videos[0]`.
F7	**Unknown URLs silently go to the home page** LOW	`user-frontend/src/App.jsx:70`	There's no "page not found" page, so mistyped or old links look like the home page. **Fix:** add a simple 404 page with links.
F8	**Footer links incomplete** LOW	`user-frontend/src/components/Footer.jsx:159-162`	Quick Links has no "Courses" link, and "Login to Account" still shows after logging in. **Fix:** add Courses; show "My Dashboard" when logged in.
F9	**Tab titles don't change on some pages** LOW	`user-frontend/src/components/SiteSEO.jsx`	The course page tab says "E-Commerce Courses" instead of the course name. Login, payment, privacy and terms all show just "Sky Birds Solution". This hurts search results and bookmarks. **Fix:** set a title per page.

F10	**Admin thumbnails point to localhost** MEDIUM	`skybird-admin/src/pages/Courses.jsx:102`	Uploaded thumbnails load from `http://localhost:5000`, so they're broken images in the live admin panel. **Fix:** build the address from `VITE_API_URL`.
F11	**Admin login doesn't redirect logged-in admins** LOW	`skybird-admin/src/pages/Login.jsx:15`	The redirect is commented out, so a logged-in admin opening `/login` sees the form again. **Fix:** restore the redirect.

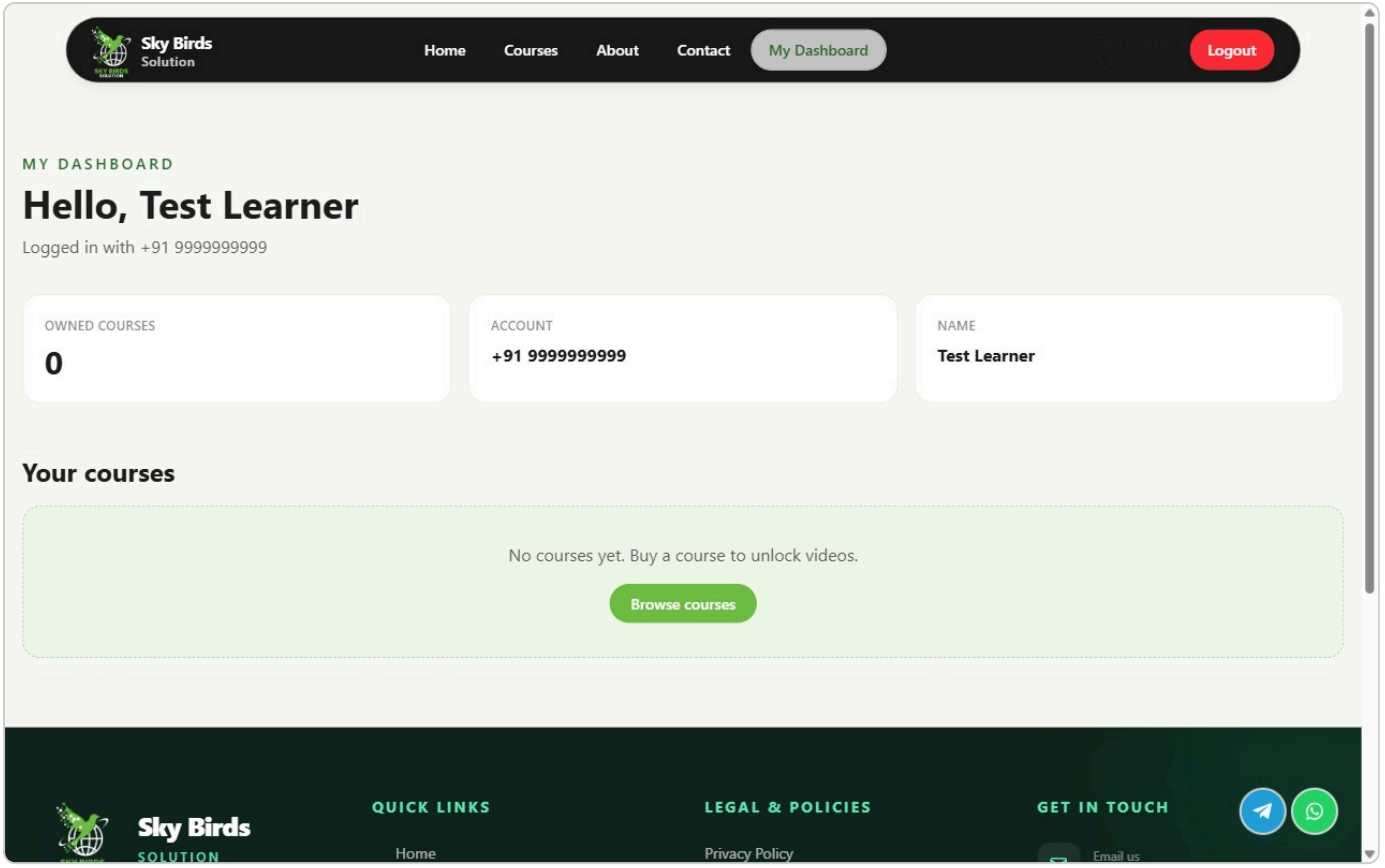
4. Visual / UI issues

ID	Issue	Where	What goes wrong / Fix
V1	**Logged-in name in the navbar almost invisible** MEDIUM	`user-frontend/src/components/Navbar.jsx:93-97`	The user's name and mobile number use dark text (`text-ink`) on the black navbar (screenshot below, top right). **Fix:** use `text-white` / `text-white/70`.
V2	**Floating buttons cover the mobile menu** LOW	`user-frontend/src/components/FloatingContactButtons.jsx`	The Telegram and WhatsApp buttons sit on top of the open mobile menu and cover its footer and Login button area. **Fix:** lower their z-index below the drawer, or hide them while the menu is open.
V3	**Course card text** LOW	`user-frontend/src/components/CourseCard.jsx`	The card says "11 Lesson" instead of "11 Lessons", and the 5-star rating is hardcoded rather than coming from real reviews. **Fix:** pluralise the label; remove the stars or use real ratings.
V4	**Courses page promises courses that don't exist** LOW	`user-frontend/src/pages/Courses.jsx`	The page mentions Amazon, Meesho and Flipkart courses, but only one Amazon course exists. **Fix:** update the text, or hide it until those courses exist.

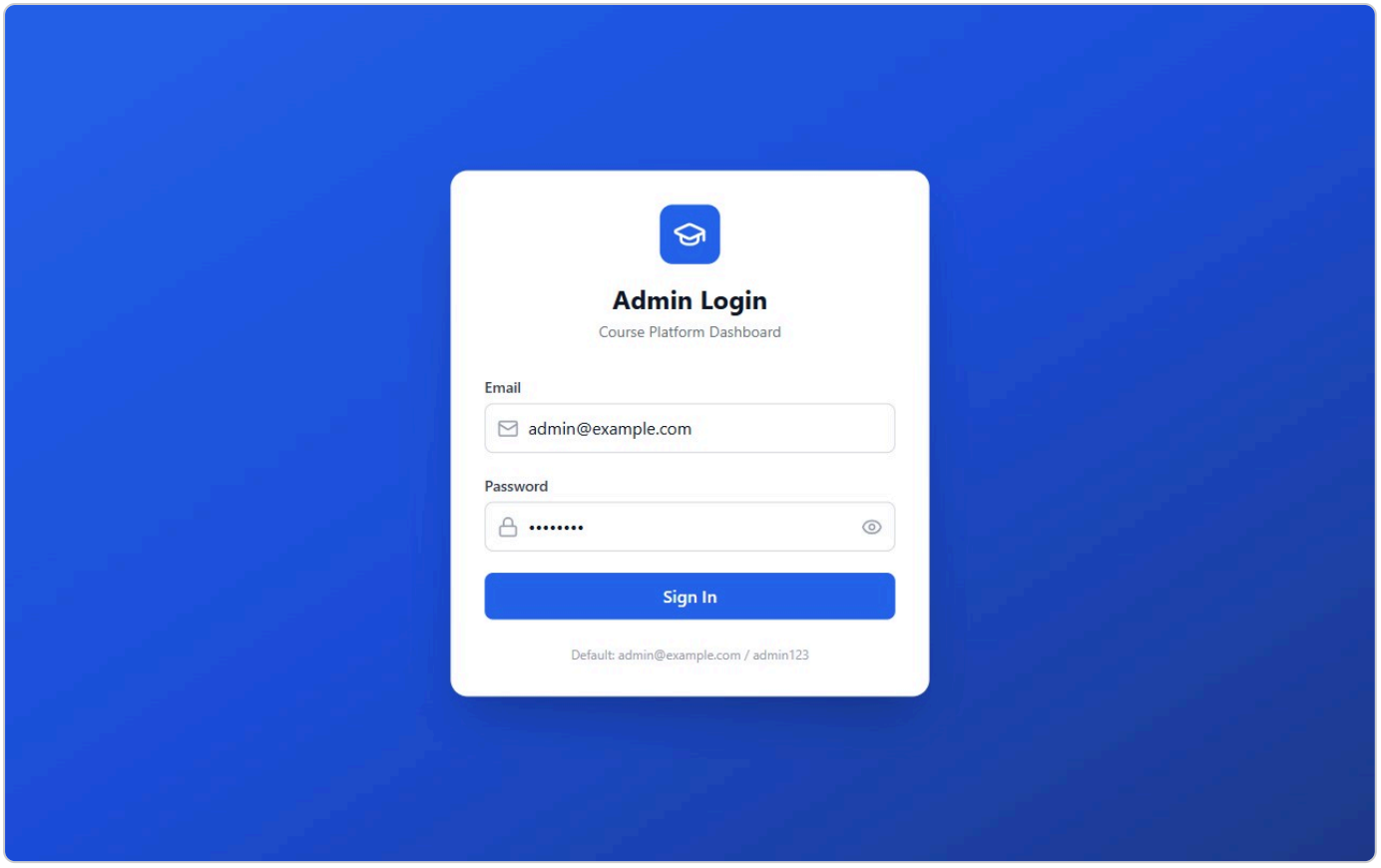
Minor / clean-up

ID	Issue	Where	What goes wrong / Fix
M1	**React error on every page**	`user-frontend/src/components/HomeVideo.jsx:274`	`<style jsx>` is Next.js syntax; in Vite it logs an error in the console. **Fix:** move those styles to `index.css`.
M2	**Site content fetched 4 times per page**	`Home, Footer, SiteSEO, Contact…`	Each component calls `/api/site` on its own. **Fix:** load it once in a shared context.
M3	**Unused frontend files**	`src/components/Home/*, src/components/About/*, Services.jsx, App.css`	About 10 components and pages are never used (sd.jsx, AboutSection, ResourcesSection, Hero1, About1, StoryMissionSection, TeamPurposeSection, AnimatedNumber, Services, App.css). **Fix:** delete them.

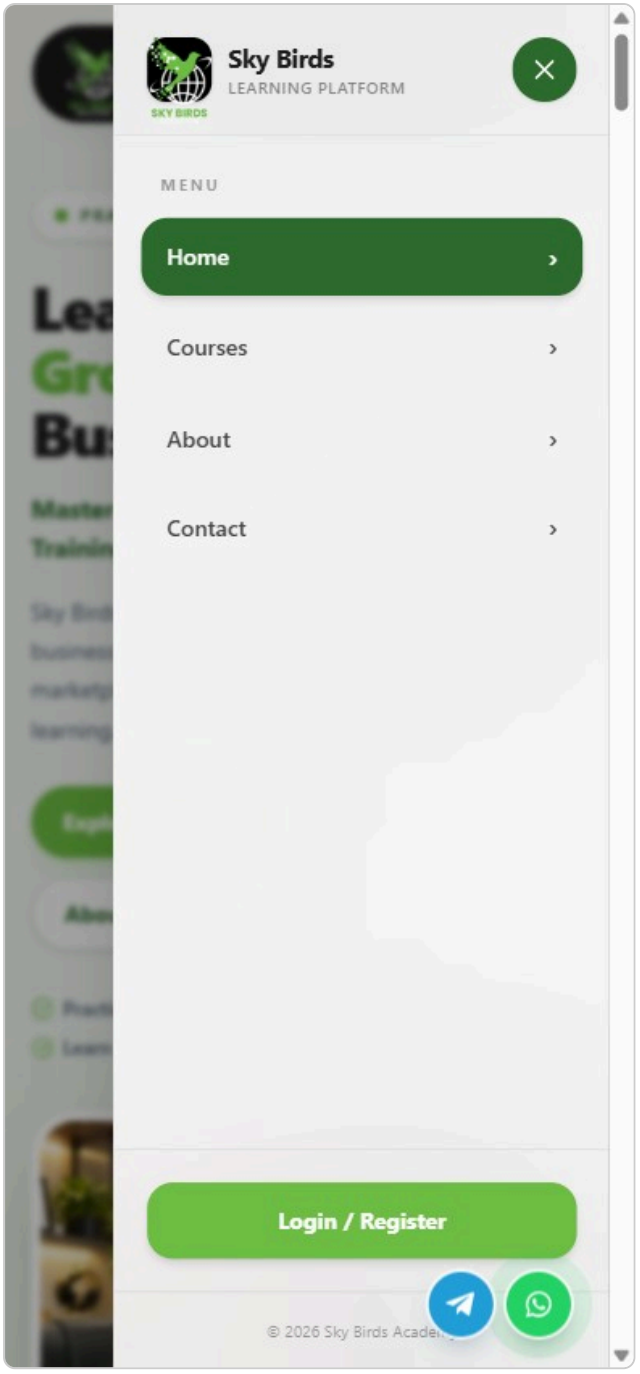
5. Screenshots



F1, F2, V1: the session token was rejected and cleared, yet the site still shows the user as logged in and the dashboard says "No courses yet". The name and number at the top right are almost invisible on the black navbar.



C4: the admin login is pre-filled and tells everyone the default credentials.



V2: the floating Telegram and WhatsApp buttons cover the bottom of the open mobile menu.

6. What was checked

Working correctly: all 14 user routes load; no broken images, empty links or "undefined" text; login-only pages redirect to `/login`; the mobile menu opens and closes; no sideways scrolling on a 390px phone; the admin sidebar links match its routes.

Not tested (would need a real account, payment or SMS against the live database): real login and OTP, a real Razorpay payment, playing a purchased lesson end to end, submitting the contact form, admin pages behind the login, and the live hosting setup.